4.15 Rheumatic Heart Disease

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I had sore throats as a child." • Says she gets breathless **Objective** • Mitral murmur • Breathless on exertion	**ACTUAL** **Decreased cardiac output** related to valve damage as evidenced by murmur and exertional dyspnea.	Within 1 week, vital signs stable and less breathless.	• Watch vital signs and look for signs of heart failure. • Give the prescribed medications. • Plan activity within what she can tolerate. • Watch for an irregular pulse (atrial fibrillation).	Symptoms controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • "Why do I need monthly injections?" **Objective** • On penicillin prophylaxis • Has missed two doses	**ACTUAL** **Deficient knowledge** related to long-term antibiotic prophylaxis as evidenced by questions.	Can explain why she needs prophylaxis and when it is due.	• Explain that it stops rheumatic fever from coming back. • Give her a card with the schedule.	Keeps to the schedule: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Damaged valves • Teeth and gums poorly cared for	**RISK** **Risk for infection** as evidenced by risk factors: damaged heart valves (endocarditis).	Keeps her teeth and gums healthy and reports fever.	• Teach oral hygiene and regular dental review. • Tell her to report a fever. • Tell her to let the dentist know she has rheumatic heart disease.	States the precautions: **goal met**.